J2 · ADAPTATION · SUDOKU BRIEF · RUNS OF 24 OCT 2026 · 1 OF 3

Realization plans and judges the work before it builds. For Sudoku, both flows passed every item. Realization wrote 7 decisions first, but used 30 more AI calls and 9 more credits.

SITUATION

The same brief went to two J2 flows: "Build me a Sudoku game as a single web page ... for casual players ... You decide the details." Both flows got 200 credits.

COMPLICATION

Base J2 cuts the charter into workflows in one AI call. Nothing checks the plan before the build. Gaps show at Audit and cost fix rounds.

RESOLUTION

Realization lists factors, makes stages, sets a certainty zone, and has a separate judge score each workflow. Decisions are written before the build starts.

First principles

BASIC FACT	SO, ADAPTATION MUST
You can build only the needs that you know about.	List the factors, also those that the brief does not state.
Each type of thinking needs its own owner.	Put each type in its own stage: product, design, engineering, build.
The method depends on how well cause and effect are known.	Read five gates. Set the zone. Shape each workflow to its zone.
A decision costs less than a rebuild.	Write decide workflows before build workflows.
A planner cannot check its own plan.	Let a separate judge answer yes/no. Let code set the score. Pass line 0.80.

Result

MEASURE	FLOW 1: BASE	FLOW 2: REALIZATION
Charter items	10	8
Planning	1 call	14 factors · 4 stages · 2 judge rounds
Decide workflows (written decisions)	0	7
Build workflows in the first cycle	5	7
Fix workflows after Audit	3	5
Audits to a full pass	3	4
Credits used, of 200	**119**	128
AI calls	**36**	66
Questions to the Requester	0	0
Final result	All items pass	All items pass

Read the next two pages from left to right

Identity: brief and charter · Realization: factors and stages · Certainty: five gates and zone · Judge and gate · Decide workflow (written decision) · Build workflow (J2 builds it) · Audit finding and fix workflow

Page 2 shows Flow 1 (base). Page 3 shows Flow 2 (realization). Each build box gives the J2 workflow id (W-n), the charter items it delivers, and, in Flow 2, the judge's last score and the decisions it reads (D-n).

Sources: J2_Realization/runs/base/j2-20261024-211320 and runs/realization/j2-20261024-213253 (goal.json, workflows.json, realization.json, decisions.md, summary.json). An earlier realization attempt at 20:30 did not finish and is not shown. Text in ASD-STE100 Simplified Technical English style.

Base J2: one AI call groups the charter items into 5 build workflows. Audit finds the gaps.

1 · GOAL → CHARTER

IDENTITY

"A friendly, uncluttered single-page Sudoku game for casual players ... with reasons for players to come back."

10 done-when items

1. One HTML file, no build step
2. 9×9 grid, number pad, locked givens
3. Easy, Medium, Hard, one solution
4. Notes, highlights, duplicates, undo
5. Hint explains, does not fill
6. Completion message, new game
7. Saves puzzle and best times
8. No sign-up, ads or tracking
9. No overflow, 44px targets
10. No JS errors, links resolve

→

2 · ADAPTATION

ONE AI CALL

Groups the charter items into workflows by section.

No factors.
No stages.
No certainty zone.
No judge.
No written decisions.

Priority funds. Coordination orders by dependency. Builders build one section each.

→

3 · BUILD WORKFLOWS (CYCLE 1)

W-1 · items 1, 2, 3
Game board, number pad and difficulty
first; others read it

W-2 · items 4, 5
Beginner help and hint
after W-1

W-3 · items 6, 7
Completion message and saved progress
after W-1

W-4 · item 8
No sign-up, no ads promise
no dependency

W-5 · items 9, 10
Phone-first styling and navigation
after W-1 to W-4

→

4 · AUDIT AND FIX ROUNDS

Audit 1 · site v7
F-7: resume does not use the game's load step

W-6 · fix F-7 · cycle 2
Resume through the game's load step

Audit 2 · site v8
F-11: digits on the page not in the charter (code check N6)

W-7 · fix F-11 · cycle 3
Pad digits drawn by CSS

W-8 · fix F-11 · cycle 3
Timer starts as a word

Audit 3 · site v10
All 10 items pass
119 of 200 credits · 36 AI calls

What Adaptation designed

- 5 workflows, each one a group of charter items.
- The design questions (palette, sizes, wording, hint style) went to the builders with no written choice.
- 2 of 3 fix workflows answered a J2 code check (N6), not a player need.

Note

- The plan was cheap: 1 call. Nothing checked it before the build.
- The charter differs from Flow 2 (10 items, best times per level, no streak counter).

3 OF 3 · FLOW 2 · REALIZATION + CERTAINTY · RUN J2-20261024-213253

Realization: 14 factors → 4 stages → zone "analyze" → 7 decisions → 7 build workflows, judged before the build.

1 · GOAL → CHARTER

IDENTITY

"A friendly, uncluttered Sudoku game ... features that make people want to come back. No sign-up and no ads."

8 done-when items

1. One file; no sign-up or ads
2. Playable grid; fits 360/1280px
3. Easy, Medium, Hard
4. Notes, undo, highlights, check, hint
5. Warm look, one main screen
6. Saved progress, streak counter
7. Congratulation, new game
8. No JS errors, links resolve

REALIZATION · FACTORS

14 factors: 8 brief, 5 general, 1 budget. Not in the brief: one solution per puzzle; levels feel different; storage may fail; fast on a phone; warm palette stays readable.

→

2 · CERTAINTY · FIVE GATES

SIGNALS

broken	no · new build
reaction	no · known return features
facts	yes · charter gives them
pattern	yes · solver, grid, storage
choices	yes · clue counts, hint wording, palette, return features

ZONE

analyze: compare options, choose, then build.

Thinking workflows: analyze. Build workflows: operate.

JUDGE · 2 ROUNDS

Plan confidence **0.85**. 0 not ready. 0 questions.

R1: "Look, layout and wording" split in 2. "Beginner helps" split; "Hint button" made. R2: "Responsive layout" split; "How to play" made.

→

3 · STAGES → DECIDE WORKFLOWS

PRODUCT · USERS, SCOPE

- D1 · 0.95 — **Scope and return-visit features**
- D2 · 0.95 — **Hint and help rules**

DESIGN · FLOWS, LOOK, WORDS

- D3 · 0.95 · split R1 — **Look and layout**
- D4 · 0.95 · split R1 — **Encouraging wording**

ENGINEERING · STRUCTURE, DATA

- D5 · 0.95 — **Single-file architecture and data model**

BUILD · NO ITEM, SO CODE TYPED THEM "DECIDE"

- D6 · 0.95 — **Beginner helps**
- D7 · 0.95 · split R2 — **How to play section**

→

4 · BUILD WORKFLOWS (STAGE "BUILD")

- W-1 · items 1, 5 — 0.85 — **Page shell and warm look** — reads D3 D4 D5
- W-2 · item 2 — 0.95 — **Playable grid and number pad** — after W-1 · reads D3 D5
- W-6 · item 3 — 0.85 — **Puzzle generator and difficulty levels** — after W-2 · reads D1 D5
- W-7 · item 4 · split R1 — 0.95 — **Hint button** — after W-6 · reads D2 D4 D5 D6
- W-3 · item 6 — 0.85 — **Saved progress and return counters** — reads D1 D5 D6
- W-4 · item 7 — 0.95 — **Completion celebration** — after W-3, W-6 · reads D3 D4
- W-5 · item 8 — 0.95 — **Responsive layout and in-page links** — after all · 0.87 → 0.62 → 0.95

→

5 · AUDIT AND FIX ROUNDS

- Audit 1 · v9 — F-6 resume · F-9, F-10 nav and wording
- W-8, W-9 · cycle 2 — Resume unfinished game · Nav, main action and plain wording
- Audit 2 · v11 — F-10 resume race · F-9 counters (N6)
- W-10, W-11 · cycle 3 — Resume race fix · Counters written by script
- Audit 3 · v13 — F-9 pad digits (N6)
- W-12 · cycle 4 — Number pad digits drawn by script
- Audit 4 · v15 — **All 8 items pass** — 128 of 200 credits · 66 AI calls

How realization and certainty work together here

- Realization made the design and engineering stages. Certainty (zone analyze) made each of them a written decision first.
- The judge split 3 workflows on the realization question "one kind of thinking". Each split made a new workflow.
- Every build workflow got its decisions (D-n) when it started.

CAUTION

- D6 and D7 sit in the build stage but deliver no item, so code typed them "decide". They became written decisions, not J2 builds. The item 4 helps were built inside W-7.
- In both flows, N6 (a J2 code check on digits) caused fix rounds that a player does not need.
- One run of each flow. The two charters are not the same.